

636 companies. Seven weeks. Key Learning / Insights

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Eight numbers that describe seven weeks.

Every figure is derived directly from the field workbook. No external data has been added.

Figure	What it is	Figure	What it is
<u>636</u>	companies visited, from 743 field visits	<u>20</u>	companies named CAFU unprompted, 16 of them negatively
182	confirmed diesel users, 28.6% of the book	58%	of measured volume sits in Cold companies, excluding one outlier account
210	more companies blocked or unresolved, not rejected	<u>27</u>	Hot leads who asked for a quote, sample or visit
<u>136</u>	leads we generated ourselves, 65.4% of them green	125	closed records caused by a wrong address, not absent demand

The uncomfortable one is 58%. The average Cold company uses 2.1 times the diesel of a Hot one.

Find out who buys diesel in the UAE, and how.

	Objective	What that meant in practice
01	Map the market	Identify businesses that consume diesel across the UAE and record how much they use.
02	Understand how they buy	Current supplier, pain points, decision maker and buying behaviour.
03	Map the competition	Who serves this market today, and where the gaps are.
04	Build awareness	Introduce FILLIT to businesses that had never heard of the name.

FILLIT delivers diesel on demand across the UAE, from 100 litres to 5 million, at a certified 10ppm specification, with GPS tracking and 24/7 dispatch. Its buyers are fleet and plant managers, site and project managers, marine operators and procurement leads.

Three days at a desk, then seven weeks on the road.

We began with desk research and cold calls for the first three days only, then moved entirely to in-person field visits.

Phase	What we did	What it told us
First 3 days	Desk research. Company websites, LinkedIn pages and trade directories to build a picture of who burns diesel in the UAE.	Gave us a starting prospect list and a working vocabulary for the industry.
First 3 days	Cold calls. Phone outreach to test the pitch and learn the objections before going door to door.	Taught us which questions actually get answered on a first contact.
Weeks 1 to 7	743 in-person field visits. Turn up, ask for the fuel buyer, run the questions, log it the same day.	Produced the entire dataset behind this presentation.

The first five questions, every time: Who supplies you today? · How much do you use? · What burns it? · What goes wrong? · Who decides?

Week 1 in the field returned a 59.5% dead-end rate even with 22 self-generated leads already in the mix. That told us the prospect list itself needed replacing.

636 companies, every one classified.

743 field visits resolved to 636 unique companies. Each is shown at its latest status; where colour and written interest level differed, interest level was used.

Status	Companies	Share	What it means
<u>Hot</u>	27	4.2%	Using diesel, high intent. Asked for a quote, sample or visit.
<u>Warm</u>	45	7.1%	Using diesel, interested, needs a follow-up.
<u>Cold</u>	110	17.3%	Confirmed diesel user, not ready to switch. A nurture list.
<u>Appointment</u>	100	15.7%	Could not get in. Free zone, permit or gate pass needed.
<u>Revisit</u>	110	17.3%	Unresolved. The process stopped; the company did not.
<u>Invalid</u>	244	38.4%	Disqualified. Mostly a wrong address rather than no demand.
<u>Total</u>	636	100%	182 confirmed diesel users. 210 more blocked or unresolved.

The addressable pool is not 182. Another 210 companies are blocked or unresolved, not rejected.

Our targets, and what each number means.

Set at the start of the internship. A plain English definition sits beside every figure.

KPI area	Measure	Result	What it means
Outreach volume	Companies contacted	636	Separate businesses reached. Each counted once.
	Field visits made	743	Total visits, including return trips.
	Emirates covered	4	Dubai, Sharjah, Ajman and Umm Al Quwain.
Lead quality	Confirmed diesel users	182	Companies that actually burn diesel. 28.6% of the book.
	Fuel buyers named	146	The person who decides, with contact details.
	<u>New leads generated</u>	136 (across all seven weeks)	Companies on no list. 65.4% of them turned green.
Standard of work	Companies classified	636	Every one given a final status. None left blank.
	Weeks delivered on time	7 of 7	Every weekly sheet consolidated on schedule.

136 new leads was a target in its own right, and those leads turned green 3.5 times more often.

Week 1 taught us to stop working the list.

Week 1 produced a 59.5% dead-end rate even with 22 self-generated leads already running. By Week 4 it had fallen to 18.8%.

Week	Visits	Hot	Warm	Cold	Green rate	Dead-end rate	New leads
<u>Week 1</u>	121	7	4	5	13.2%	59.5%	22
<u>Week 2</u>	120	4	15	26	37.5%	30.0%	15
<u>Week 3</u>	96	1	5	24	31.2%	30.2%	18
<u>Week 4</u>	96	4	6	16	27.1%	18.8%	19
<u>Week 5</u>	116	5	3	11	16.4%	19.8%	20
<u>Week 6</u>	102	2	6	14	21.6%	46.1%	15
<u>Week 7</u>	92	4	7	16	29.3%	29.3%	27
Total	743	27	46	112	24.9%	32.8%	136

From Week 2 the dead-end rate held between 19% and 30%. Week 6 spiked to 46.1% on revisits and gated sites; Week 7 recovered to 29.3% on our largest weekly batch of self-generated leads.

Every major pain point appears only beside a live lead.

Text-mined from the comments, pain points, fleet and supplier fields across all 636 companies. A company can raise more than one.

Pain point	Companies	Hot	Warm	Cold	Share green	Severity
Equipment, generator and forklift	76	15	23	29	88%	Major
Vehicles driven to a station	31	5	13	12	97%	Major
Price and rate	27	11	11	4	96%	Major
CAFU service failure	20	6	13	1	100%	Major
Delivery and on-site refuelling	19	4	12	1	89%	Major
Fuel quality and 10ppm spec	18	4	7	7	100%	Major
ADNOC / ENOC chip and prepaid friction	19	4	8	7	100%	Moderate
Credit and payment terms	10	4	6	0	100%	High value
Trust and vendor verification	5	1	3	0	80%	Moderate
Minimum order quantity	1	1	0	0	100%	Isolated

76 companies raised equipment, generator or forklift refuelling. Price, CAFU and fuel quality appear only beside companies that use diesel.

Who decides, how they buy, and what they told us.

Drawn from 743 field visits. Quotations are verbatim, original spelling retained.

How they buy	Evidence	What they said	Company
Fuel decision sits with a named buyer	146 named	"They used to take from Cafu, but cafu stopped delivering"	SHJ Carbon Factory, Hot
Usually procurement, accounts, operations or owner	By role	"Low quality fuel is reducing their vehicle's efficiency"	Uniforce Contracting, Hot
Locked into ADNOC / ENOC chip or prepaid cards	19 cos.	"ADNOC has minimum quantity requirement"	SCA Shipping, Hot
Buys from unverified independent traders	39 cos.	"Contract with CAFU in 2025 but they stole their credit"	Al Jalal Trading, Warm
Drives vehicles to a retail station	36 cos.	"No trust on door step delivery"	Main Crete Contracting, Warm
Asks for credit terms before switching	10 cos.	"Facing problems with ADNOC chip, need to topup"	Daira Carpentry, Warm

The common objections are reliability, quality, trust and access. Almost none are about price.

100 companies are blocked, not disqualified.

Free zone entry, appointment protocols and gate passes. All solvable with administration rather than more visits.

Barrier	Companies	What is actually needed
Inside a free zone	49	A registered free-zone access pass. JAFZA, Hamriyah and Dubai Industrial City.
Booked appointment required	51	A scheduled meeting rather than a walk-in. Mostly larger corporates.
Gate pass required	46	Site-level security clearance, usually arranged in advance by the client.
Of which: Jebel Ali / JAFZA	65	65 companies visited, 42 blocked at the gate, and zero Hot leads recorded.

A company can face more than one barrier, so the rows overlap. The workbook has a Passes Required field for this problem; it holds two entries against 100 blocked companies.

Buying access is cheaper than buying more field days.

Metals converted at 67%. Contracting took 34% of our visits and returned 24%.

Green rate means the share of companies confirmed as diesel users: Hot, Warm or Cold.

Industry	Visited	Hot	Warm	Cold	Green rate	New leads
Metal, steel and aluminium	21	5	4	4	66.7%	6
Food and beverage	21	2	4	4	47.6%	7
Auto workshop and equipment	19	1	1	6	42.1%	3
Plastics and packaging	23	0	2	6	34.8%	3
Manufacturing and factory	51	5	4	7	31.4%	4
Marine, boats and shipping	81	4	5	14	28.4%	36
Trading	18	0	2	3	27.8%	2
Building and civil contracting	214	7	12	33	24.3%	37
Electro-mechanical and MEP	5	0	0	1	20.0%	0
Transport, logistics and fleet	74	1	4	9	18.9%	7
Healthcare	14	0	0	2	14.3%	0
Other / unclassified	95	2	7	20	30.5%	31

Marine and boat building is the sleeper: 81 companies, and 36 of our 136 self-generated leads came from it.

Al Sajaa returned 84.6% green. Jebel Ali returned no Hot leads at all.

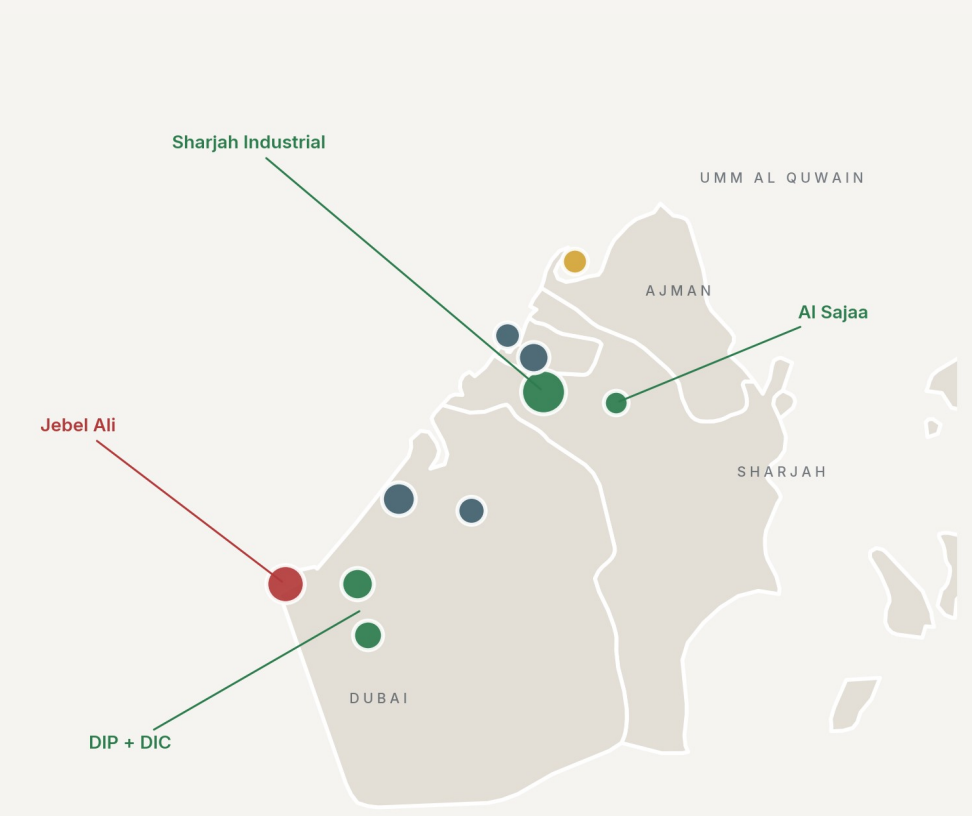
Jebel Ali is not a demand problem. 42 of its 65 companies were blocked at the gate.

Area	Companies visited	Green rate	Visits per Hot lead
Al Sajaa, Sharjah	13	84.6%	13 visits
Warsan / International City	29	55.2%	14 visits
Nadd Al Hamar	6	50.0%	no Hot leads
Dubai Investment Park	37	45.9%	18 visits
Dubai Industrial City	34	44.1%	8 visits
Al Jurf, Ajman	16	37.5%	16 visits
Sharjah Industrial Areas	52	34.6%	13 visits
Al Quoz	46	26.1%	46 visits
Umm Al Quwain	16	25.0%	16 visits
Dubai Silicon Oasis	21	23.8%	no Hot leads
Business Bay / Jumeirah / Barsha	92	22.8%	31 visits
Ajman Industrial Area	56	21.4%	28 visits
Jebel Ali / JAFZA	65	18.5%	no Hot leads

Dubai Industrial City and DIP together: 71 companies at 45% green, and 20 self-generated leads.

Four territories to work, one to stop visiting.

Only the areas we actually covered are shown. Abu Dhabi was not part of this programme.



	Territory	Why
1	Sharjah Industrial Areas + Al Sajaa	65 companies at 34.6% and 84.6% green. Street by street sweep.
2	Dubai Investment Park + Dubai Industrial City	71 companies at 45% green, and 20 self-generated leads.
3	Jebel Ali / JAFZA	65 companies, 42 blocked at the gate. Needs passes, not visits.
4	Al Jurf + Ajman Industrial	72 companies. Worth a second sweep with verified addresses.
Stop	Business Bay, Jumeirah, Silicon Oasis	113 companies returned 26 green and 3 Hot. Registered offices, not sites.

No supplier owns this market, and CAFU has created a vacuum.

Of the 122 companies that named a supplier, the largest single group buys from independent traders.

Current supplier	Companies	Hot	Warm	Cold	What their customers say
Independent third-party traders	39	13	9	15	Quality and trust complaints cluster here.
ADNOC	31	6	15	10	Price, contract difficulty, minimum quantities.
Self-fuelling at retail stations	36	3	17	15	Not a supplier relationship at all. The competitor is the pump.
ENOC / EPPCO	30	3	10	16	Price.
CAFU	20 mentioned	2	3	0	Withdrawal and service failure. 16 of 20 mentions are negative.
Emarat	1	-	-	-	Marginal presence in this dataset.

Pricing context: UAE diesel is price-regulated at AED 4.30 per litre (September 2026), so every station charges the same. CAFU reinstated delivery fees of AED 12 to 20 per order in April 2025. FILLIT's differentiators are therefore delivery, 10ppm quality, no minimum order and pricing issued before dispatch, not the litre price.

36 companies have no delivered-fuel supplier at all. They drive to a station. The competitor is the pump.

Our own scoring was pointing at the wrong companies.

Across the 90 Hot, Warm and Cold companies whose consumption converts to litres per month, excluding one outlier account.

58%

of measured diesel volume sits in companies we scored Cold.

RP Group (Hot, about 4.5 million litres a month) is excluded because it alone would outweigh everything else combined.

Measure	Hot	Warm	Cold
Companies with measured volume	20	35	35
Total litres per month	317,123	497,376	1,139,293
Share of measured volume	16.2%	25.5%	58.3%
Average per company	15,856 L	14,211 L	32,551 L

Escalate the top 10 Cold accounts by volume to a named account manager. The average Cold company uses 2.1x a Hot one.

Six customer problems, and the opening each one creates.

Each row is a named group of companies in the handover files, not a market segment estimate.

Customer problem	Companies	The commercial opening it creates
CAFU stopped delivering or will not fill on site	20	Direct replacement of a withdrawn supplier. No price fight required.
Vehicles and machinery driven to a fuel station	31	Sell downtime recovery, not a cheaper litre. Price is regulated, time is not.
Bad fuel from independent traders	18	Verifiable 10ppm with batch certification. Nine of ten quality specs asked for 10ppm.
ADNOC minimum quantities and chip friction	19	No-minimum delivery and post-paid terms. The exclusion is itself a market.
Credit and working capital	10	Structured terms. Four of the ten credit requests are already Hot.
Forklift, generator and machinery refuelling	76	The largest group of all. None of this equipment can be driven to a pump.

Not one of these six openings is a price argument.

72 qualified companies, named and profiled.

Seven of each shown. Every one has a named contact, a known current supplier and a recorded fleet.

<u>27 Hot leads</u>	Area	Buys from today
RP Group, Gulf Asian Contracting	Ajman	Multiple 3rd party traders
Saif Al Saleh Transport	Warsan / Int'l City	Welcome Diesel Trading
Merint Interior	Dubai Industrial City	ENOC (chip)
Poorav Chemical Transport	Warsan / Int'l City	Silver Homes
Sun Metal Casting Factory	Sharjah Industrial	Third party
Al Fanous Al Fadhi Glass	Al Sajaa	Drives to fuel station
MGM General Contracting	Dubai	Maxwell Fuel Trading

<u>45 Warm leads</u>	Area	Buys from today
Ardh Al Madina Group	Ras Al Khor	Musajal Fuel
Rhenus Logistics Gulf	Jebel Ali / JAFZA	Fuel pump (chip)
Emcon Contracting	Al Quoz	Fuel station + 3rd party
JAIDE Express Freight	Warsan / Int'l City	ADNOC (chip)
Al Shamsi Boat Factory	Ajman	Ajwa Diesel Trading
AFAQ Engineering	Dubai	GP Golden
Dayal Metal Containers	Ajman	ADNOC (chip)

Full lists for Hot, Warm, Cold, self-generated leads and CAFU-affected accounts are handed over as separate Excel files with this deck.

Eleven of these fourteen drive to a pump or buy from an unverified trader. Each is a direct switching opportunity.

The leads we found ourselves beat the list on every measure.

136 companies identified by walking in across all seven weeks, against the 500 companies from the planned list.

Lead source	Companies	Green	Green rate	Dead ends	Dead-end rate
<u>Self-generated in the field</u>	136	89	65.4%	19	14.0%
The planned prospect list	500	93	18.6%	225	45.0%

What that difference means
3.5x better green rate than the prospect list we were handed.
3.2x lower dead-end rate, because we chose the address ourselves rather than trusting a stale list.
36 of the 136 came from marine and boat building alone, a sector nobody had targeted.
Week 7 alone produced 27 self-generated leads, our largest weekly batch, and still beat the list on every measure.
Self-generated leads carry the largest accounts in the entire book, including RP Group.

Top five findings, and what each means for FILLIT.

	Finding	Field evidence, and what it means for FILLIT's growth
01	The demand is real, sizeable and already named	72 qualified companies report 814,499 litres a month (about AED 42M a year), excluding RP Group, which alone reports 4.5M litres a month. FILLIT has a named revenue pipeline, not a market estimate.
02	The biggest volumes sit with the slowest buyers	Excluding RP Group, 58% of measured volume sits in Cold companies, averaging 32,551 L a month against 15,856 L for Hot. Growth needs key-account management, not just fast follow-ups.
03	FILLIT wins on service, because price is fixed	36 companies still drive to a pump and 39 buy from unverified traders. Diesel is regulated at AED 4.30 a litre, so the objections we heard were reliability, quality and access, not price.
04	A competitor has left the door open	20 companies raised CAFU unprompted, 16 negatively, and every one of them uses diesel. This is the fastest share gain available, with no price war required.
05	Factories and site equipment are the sweet spot	Metals converted at 67%, Al Sajaa at 84.6% and DIC with DIP at 45%. 76 companies raised generator, forklift or machinery refuelling, which no fuel station can serve.

Top five recommendations to grow FILLIT.

	Recommendation	Why, from the field	Target
01	Turn the 72 qualified leads into first orders	27 Hot leads asked for a quote, sample or visit. Their measured demand is 814,499 L a month.	First orders from 10 accounts in 60 days
02	Launch a Site Equipment Fuelling offer	76 companies need forklifts, generators or plant refuelled on site, a need no station can meet.	15 paid trials in 90 days
03	Win the accounts CAFU has lost	20 identified companies, 16 of them unhappy, already buy delivered diesel and want a reliable supplier.	8 switched accounts in 90 days
04	Put the top 10 Cold accounts under a key-account manager	Cold holds 58% of measured volume. Two conversions at the Cold average add about 65,000 L a month.	2 contracts, about 65,000 L a month
05	Reposition FILLIT on service, backed by content	Price is regulated, so reliability, 10ppm quality and no minimum order must be the message. LinkedIn sits near 350 followers.	1,000 followers and 25 inbound leads a quarter

Ready to implement this month, and the business impact.

Ready to implement	First step	Expected business impact
Quote pack for the 27 Hot leads	Price, delivery terms, 10ppm certificate and a sample invoice sent to each named contact.	27 live negotiations against 317,123 L a month of measured Hot demand.
CAFU switch offer	One-page offer plus a call list of the 20 affected companies.	Share gained from a competitor, without discounting.
Site Equipment Fuelling pilot	Free first on-site fill for 5 forklift or generator sites in Al Sajaa and DIC.	A proven, referenceable use case stations cannot copy.
Key accounts for the top 10 Cold	Named owner, quarterly review and credit terms for each account.	Access to a 1,139,293 L a month pool of larger buyers.
Free-zone access	File access passes for JAFZA, Hamriyah and DIC.	Unlocks 100 blocked companies, including 42 in JAFZA.
<u>LinkedIn and white paper launch</u>	Publish Week 1 creative and gate the white paper behind a short form.	Inbound leads and brand recall from about 350 followers today.

Every action uses assets already built. Qualified demand alone is worth about AED 42M a year.

The growth plan: three months, then months four to six.

One plan across sales, marketing and operations. Every action traces back to a field finding.

Window	Goal	Actions across sales, marketing and operations	KPI to track
Days 1 to 30	Win the warm pipeline	Sales: quote all 27 Hot leads, call the 45 Warm, send the CAFU switch offer. Marketing: publish LinkedIn Weeks 1 and 2 and the white paper. Ops: add a pre-visit address check.	27 quotes sent, 5 first orders
Days 31 to 60	Expand where demand concentrates	Sales: assign the top 10 Cold accounts, sweep Al Sajaa, DIC and DIP. Marketing: Weeks 3 and 4 plus a forklift case study. Ops: file free-zone passes.	10 key accounts, 10 equipment trials
Days 61 to 90	Make growth repeatable	Move all 636 companies into a CRM with outcome tracking. Score leads on volume as well as interest. Publish a UAE diesel buyer report to drive inbound demand.	Conversion rate by sector and zone
Months 4 to 6	Scale what converts	Enter JAFZA with passes, open Hamriyah and Umm Al Quwain, launch a customer referral offer, and review credit terms for key accounts.	Litres a month under contract, 1,000 followers

182 confirmed diesel users, 72 qualified, 20 leaving a competitor. The plan turns them into contracted litres.

A four-week LinkedIn plan, written post by post.

28 posts, all 10 content pillars, 13 formats. Week 1 creative is designed and ready. Built on this field research.

Week	Objective	Posts written	Status
Week 1	Frame the problem	Poll on the biggest refuelling bottleneck. Carousel on dead mileage and idle wages. Generator damage post. White paper launch with a comment-gated CTA.	Creative complete, 10 images
Week 2	Prove the difference	10ppm against standard fuel in a Euro 5/6 engine. Night refuelling carousel. Fuel as a service. The drivers behind the deliveries.	Full copy written
Week 3	Show the system	Free dead-mileage and ROI audit for 10 fleets. Paper logbooks post. The five-step delivery workflow. The eight-point continuity checklist.	Full copy written
Week 4	Convert	Resilience by design. 100 litres to 5 million. Emergency top-ups. The dispatch team. One month on from the white paper.	Full copy written

Engagement rules that shaped it: links go in the first comment, never the post body · comment-gated CTAs beat link clicks · thought leadership publishes from the founder profile · LinkedIn does not expose poll voters, so follow up with commenters

What we did, what got in the way, and how we solved it.

Tasks assigned	Challenge	How we solved it	Tools and platforms
Visited 636 companies in 743 visits across four emirates	The list was stale: 59.5% dead ends in Week 1	Built our own leads, which reached 65.4% green	Excel: 743-visit log
Interviewed fuel buyers on supplier, volume, equipment and pain points	125 companies had moved or the address was wrong	Logged the reason, so each one is recoverable	Python (Claude code): cleaning, analysis
Introduced FILLIT and left flyers at every site	100 sites were behind gates or in free zones	Logged as blocked, not lost, and planned passes	Google Maps: routes
Logged and colour-coded every visit the same day	Reception would not connect us	Asked for the fuel buyer by role: 146 named	LinkedIn: research
Found 136 new leads beyond the supplied list	Usage given in litres, gallons and dirhams	Converted everything to litres a month	WhatsApp: team updates
Turned the data into a growth plan and LinkedIn strategy	Colour and written status disagreed on 26 rows	Applied the written interest level	PowerPoint: reporting

Each challenge became a recommendation FILLIT can act on, from address checks to free-zone passes.

My contribution, what I learned, and what FILLIT keeps.

My individual contribution	Files and assets handed over
Field visits and fuel-buyer interviews across Dubai, Sharjah, Ajman and Umm Al Quwain	Master database: 636 companies with overrides, weekly, sector and zone sheets
Designed the capture sheet and colour-coded status system used for all 743 visits	Hot (27), Warm (45) and Cold (110) lead files, ready for the sales team
Verified the master database: 636 companies, latest status, 26 conflicts resolved	Self-generated leads (136) and CAFU-affected accounts (20)
Analysed demand by sector, territory, supplier, pain point, volume and lead source	Blocked and revisit list (210) for access and follow-up planning
Turned the findings into FILLIT's growth plan, targets and 90-day roadmap	LinkedIn strategy, Week 1 creative and the 2026 white paper
Wrote the 4-week LinkedIn strategy (28 posts) and the 2026 white paper	This deck, with speaker notes and sources
Team: Mudar, Gautham, Parasharan and Divesh shared field visits, client conversations, flyers and data logging equally	
Key learnings from the internship	
Interest shows who will talk; volume shows who matters. FILLIT should score leads on both.	
In a price-regulated market, service wins. Every objection we heard was reliability, quality or access.	
Clean data is a growth lever. A verified address is worth as much as another day in the field.	

